

Summer Time Rendering

A psychological thriller of an anime that sailed by under the radar

Summer Time Rendering is a 25 episode anime whose first episode aired on 15th April, 2022. Yup, that's right. This anime was released in the Spring of 2022 which means that its rivals were Spy X Family and Kaguya Sama: Love is War Season 3 and hence this anime went under the radar of many avid anime watchers. We stumbled upon it because we like watching time travel and psychological thrillers and after 25 episodes, here we are - praising the heck out of this one.

The story's main character is Ajiro Shinpei who is visiting his home after two years. His home is a small island of about 5 km radius and a population of 700 people in total. This means that essentially, everybody knows everybody on this island. He left his home to pursue culinary school in Tokyo. He is coming home because his step-sister Kofune Ushio is dead and he wants to say a final goodbye. Anyways, he gets off the ferry and performs the final rights to let his step-sister rest in peace where he gets interrupted by his friend Sou who claims that Ushio's death wasn't an accident, it was a murder. A thought of suspicion gets raised in his mind but he brushes it off. Anyways, his day continues further as normal until the evening. In the evening, he gets shot in the head by someone. Who shot Shinpei? From attending the last rites of his step-sister to literally getting shot, what happened? We can't tell you because we want to avoid



spoilers as much as possible. Anyways, after getting shot, something strange happens. Shinpei doesn't die. Well, he does but he immediately wakes up on the morning of the same day when he got off the ferry. Well, that's weird and cool at the same time! If he dies, this guy literally has the ability to just travel to the past and undo his death, right? He's immortal because no matter how many times you kill him, he will just wake up in the past and undo his death, right? Wrong! Just like Re: Zero (if you've watched it, you'll know) this guy CAN just wake up in the past if he dies but unlike Re: Zero, he only has a finite number of times to use this ability. Now that's just the main character Shinpei for you. The main plot of this story is the shadows. You see, the island that Shinpei and his friends

live on - Hitogashima - has a little bit of history attached to it. There always has been an urban legend that "shadows" exist on this island. These shadows can mimic the look and personality of any human that they like, copy their memories too and then replace them altogether by killing them. They don't need food to eat and they don't need air to breathe. These beings are just there to liberate the whole island and replace all humans and the worst part, they look literally indistinguishable from their human counterparts.

The best and the worst part of this anime were its characters. Granted, the plot and the story of this whole anime made up for the lack of depth of each of the characters but still, we felt that the should've introduced us or at least gave us some time to get acquainted with the characters in the show. Our main complaint is that many characters are just introduced and immediately amalgamated into the plot line. If the show had a running time of 12 episodes, this would've been justified but since it's 25 episodes long, we personally did not connect with many characters in this anime. Also, the best part of this anime is the restrictions that the plot puts on the main character - Shinpei. Even though he has the ability to just travel back in time each time he dies, he cannot do it indefinitely and his time travel definitely comes with a cost. This keeps the main character grounded and in the same plane as the rest of the characters. The last thing that we liked about this anime was the antagonist. We absolutely loved all the plot twists at the end related to the antagonist that we frankly, did not see coming at all and we bet that you won't either.

All in all, we highly suggest that you watch this anime as it has a sprinkle of everything. From romance and fan service to blood, gore and trauma. It has everything and throughout its 25 episode run time, it has kept us on the edge of our seats and did not bore us even once. Summer Time Rendering is a must-watch from our side.

—Kshipra 'faafdaajalebii' Jadav